

Navigation as a concept

Navigation types in iOS

Navigation is the mechanism that allows users to move from one view to another in an iOS app. Its the transition from 1 screen to another

Navigation Patterns

Primary ways

- Hierarchical
- Modal
- Tab

iOS gives us 3 main navigation patterns.

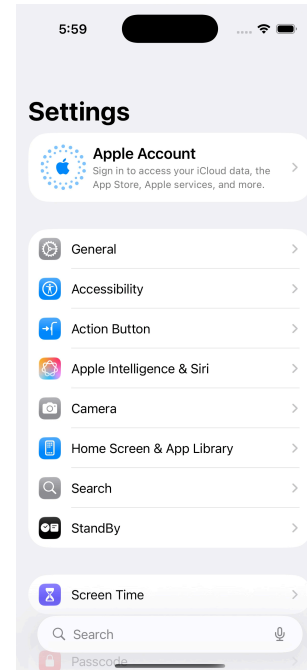
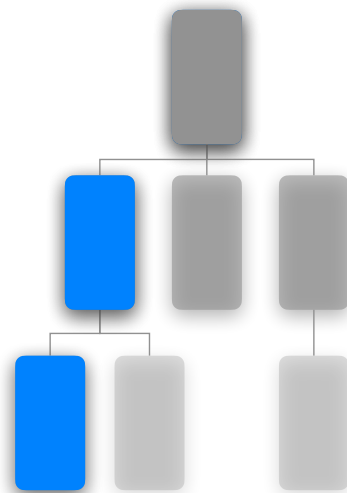
Hierarchical - for drilling down through content.

Modal - for temporary, focused tasks.

Tab - for equal, parallel sections.

Each solves a different organizational challenge. Let's dive into each one.

Hierarchical Navigation



It follows progressive disclosure by revealing complexity gradually.

Start at Settings - your root.

Push animation to General

Tap General - you go deeper.

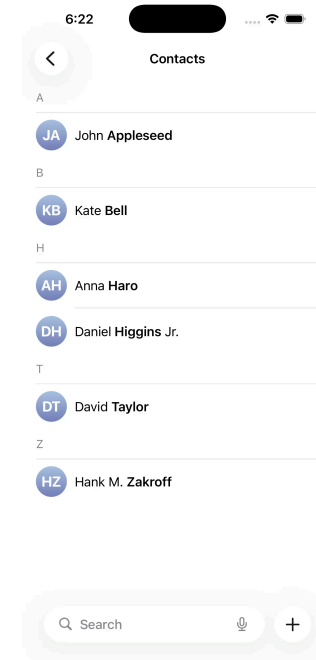
Tap About - you go deeper

If you were to use an analogy/data structure to implement this behavior which would you use (Queues/Stacks/Dictionary)? Stack

When you transition through hierarchical navigation, a view is pushed into the stack, which means a person has tapped on an element and the next screen slides into view with a **right to left animation**. A **push transition** is an expected default when drilling further into an app's hierarchy. It's a literal representation of moving through content from a high level and drilling into more detail.

Modal Navigation

- Self contained task
- Bottom up animation



On the other hand, a **modal** is reserved for a self-contained task in an interface.

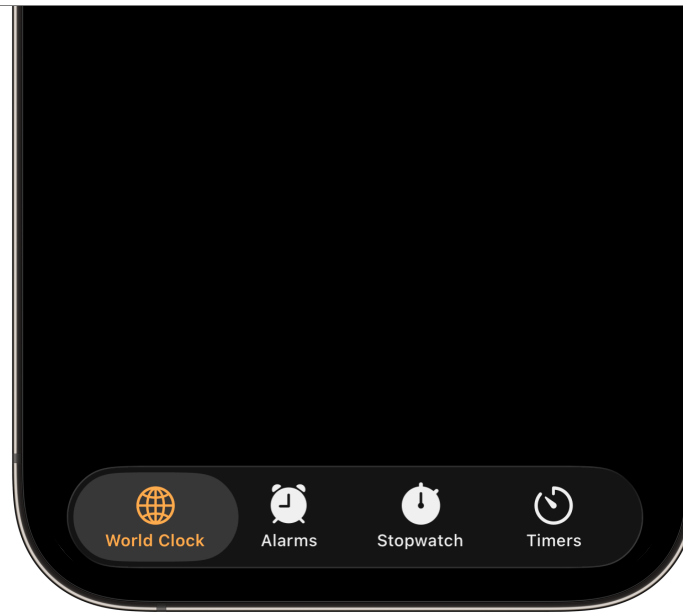
Modals work great for workflows that are independent, meaning someone has enough information in that view to make decisions and complete a task.

Modals are unique because they create focus by separating people from the information hierarchy.

The tab bar is hidden while there is a screen being presented modally.

Tab Navigation

- Global navigation control
- Categorizes into tabs
 - equal in importance
 - parallel in hierarchy



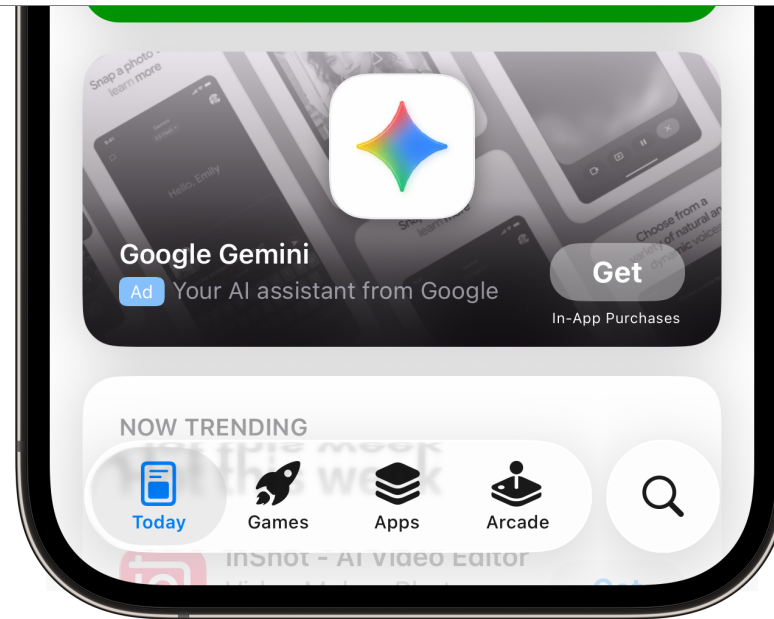
Tab bars are a global navigation control that sit at the bottom of the screen, categorizing an app's content into different sections.

Think of tabs as a control to reflect your information hierarchy. The UI control itself should translate an already-clear grouping and establish relationship between different areas of your app.

So the Tab bar represents your top-level content, which should be the top of your app's hierarchy. Each tab communicates your app's menu of options, and these sections should be meaningful and descriptive.

A good example of usage of tab bars is the clock app that has self explanatory tabs which are very clearly parallel and independent in nature of the work they deal with.

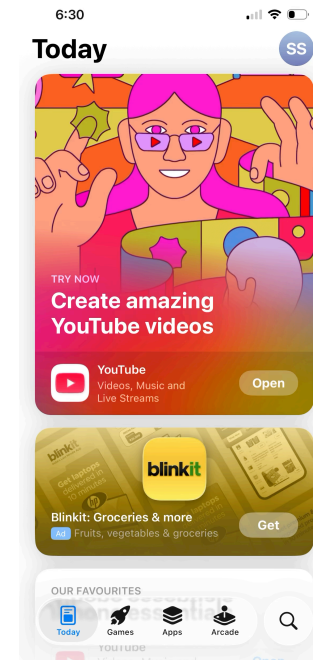
Tab Navigation AppStore



Another good example of tab bar is in the AppStore app.

Tab Navigation

AppStore



All tabs in the AppStore also depict independent navigation hierarchies that function in parallel.